between the Congress, the P.S.P. and the Communist Party' were 'mostly on degree rather than kind'.[57] The similarity between the broad ideas in the four manifestos was such that responsible 'Congressmen, Praja Socialists, Communists and Jan Sanghis separately emphasised here today: "Beware of deception". They agreed that differences among the four lay not so much in four roads to Socialism as of four buses of different makes and design on the highway to socialism or economic democracy. And each of them said: "We want the voter to know that any other bus than ours will not take him to the desired destination—the Socialist Paradise." '[58]

The main difference was that, while the Congress wanted to nationalise strategic industries, the Jan Sangh wanted to nationalise only basic and defence industries. All parties agreed that the private sector's role was to aid the development of India. All four said much the same on welfare schemes, unemployment, women and minorities. The only difference really was the Jan Sangh's emphasis on 'the entire panorama of Indian life, with the single purpose of reviving Bharatiya culture' and its focus on 'Akhand Bharat'.[59] As then Jan Sangh President Balraj Madhok argued in 1966, 'we are not guided by any "ism". We neither believe in socialism nor in capitalism nor in communism. The only "isms" we believe in are realism and nationalism. All our policies must be guided by the national interest and all our policies must be made with an eye on the Indian conditions.'[60]

By 1973, the Sangh's approach had become practical, not based on theoretical dogmas. As Vajpayee put it, 'It rejected both complete nationalisation as well as free enterprise and favoured a middle course. It advocated nationalisation of defence industries but in respect of other industries suggested an approach which under overall State regulation, "encouraged private enterprise to expand in the interests of consumers and producers" alike. The three-pronged approach—growth in production, equity in distribution and restraint in consumption—commended by the Jana Sangh in 1951, is as valid today as it was then.'[61] Note the restraint on consumption. The Jan Sangh was always very leftist on luxuries. For instance, when there is an increase in purchasing power in rural areas, the party noted